

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN, KOLKATA REGION

PRE- BOARD EXAMINATION - 2025-2026

CLASS- X

MAX MARKS- 80

SUB- ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE

TIME- 3 HOURS

General Instructions:

This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.

1. The Question Paper contains THREE sections.
2. Section A- READING
3. Section B- GRAMMAR AND WRITING
4. Section D- LITERATURE

SECTION A- READING (20 MARKS)

1. Read the following passage and answer the questions carefully:

10 Marks

Plastic is one of the major inorganic solid waste fractions in our daily municipal solid waste (MSW) production. Ever-increasing population, rapid urbanization, and industrial advancement are some of the key driving factors for creating critical man-made problems that eventually threaten the existence of living beings on this earth. With the industrial scale adoption of synthetic polymer in the 1940s, a new era of materials and manufacturing technologies was unlocked. Plastic has been a ubiquitous commodity for more than 50 years in every aspect of our lives, covering households, construction, packaging, health care, automotive, etc. It is mainly a petroleum-derived non-biodegradable with a unique polymeric structure that offers low specific weight, low thermal and electrical conductivity, and high durability (plastic bags-20 years, plastic bottles-450 years, fishing line-600 years), excellent mechanical properties, reasonable pricing, etc. Plastic materials like polyethene (PE), polypropylene (PP), polyvinylchloride (PVC), and polyethene terephthalate (PET) contain linear chains and flexible structures to offer an easy modification to any shape by applying heat.

However, pure plastics need additives (plasticisers, stabilisers) to attain certain desired properties as they have higher degradability with lower thermal, mechanical, and physical properties. This development of plastics not only eases human life in a convenient way but also generates a large volume of waste which is hazardous and poses threats to all living beings and to the environment. Plastics, in the form of bottles, bags, containers, cups, accessories, packaging materials, etc., make a significant portion (about 10–13%) of the total inorganic content in MSW. At present, plastics, metals, glass, papers and many other organic and inorganic contents from MSW and megacities around the world are suffering badly to handle this increasing volume of MSW.

It is estimated that single used plastic products (polybags, food utensils, packaging materials, etc.) contribute about 50% of that plastic waste and end up their journey in landfill sites or in the marine environment. An extensive research focus should be given to the post-consumer of plastic products, even for thermoplastics (polypropylene, polyethylene, high-density polyethylene), to tackle the environmental challenges. As every individual polymer group has their identical physical and chemical composition, understanding the characteristics properties are essential to estimate about the recycling and energy recovery potential from these polymer groups. However, sustainable waste management planning, sharing technical know-how among developed and undeveloped countries, conducting campaigns to make aware mass people about the adverse effect of plastic pollution as well as their role as global citizen to minimise this impact are the primary considerations to enjoy the full advantages of plastic.

- | | | |
|-------|---|---|
| i) | How is the existence of the living beings threatened? | 1 |
| ii) | Why has plastic become an important commodity? | 2 |
| iii) | Complete the following appropriately.
Plasticisers are needed _____ | 1 |
| iv) | Paraphrase the line- "This development of plastics not only eases human life in a convenient way but also generates a large volume of waste which is hazardous and poses threats to all living beings and to the environment." | 1 |
| v) | Complete the analogy.
Unique: individual :: _____: _____ | 1 |
| vi) | State whether TRUE or FALSE.
It is approximated that single-used plastic products have come up with about 50% of the plastic waste and ultimately get disposed of in landfill sites or in the marine environment. | 1 |
| vii) | What are the possible ways for plastic waste management? | 2 |
| viii) | A new era of materials and manufacturing technologies was unlocked _____
a. With the industrial scale adoption of synthetic polymer in the 1940s
b. With sustainable waste management planning
c. By attaining certain desired properties of the plastics
d. By every individual polymer group having their identical physical and chemical composition | 1 |

2. Read the following passage and answer the questions carefully:

10 Marks

The Amazon Rainforest, often referred to as the "lungs of the Earth," is the largest tropical rainforest in the world, spanning across nine countries in South America. It covers an area of approximately 5.5 million square kilometres and is home to an estimated 10% of all known plant and animal species. The Amazon River, which runs through the rainforest, is

the largest river by discharge volume, accounting for about 15% of the fresh water flowing into the oceans.

The Amazon Rainforest plays a critical role in regulating the global climate, producing about 20% of the world's oxygen, and absorbing massive amounts of carbon dioxide. It is also a vital source of livelihood for millions of people, including indigenous communities who have lived in the forest for thousands of years. The green leaf area of plants and trees in the rainforest varies by about 25% as a result of seasonal changes. Leaves expand during the dry season when sunlight is at a maximum, then undergo abscission in the cloudy wet season. These changes provide a balance of carbon between photosynthesis and respiration.¹

The rainforest contains several species that can pose a hazard. Among the largest predatory creatures are the black caiman, jaguar, cougar, and anaconda. In the river, electric eels can produce an electric shock that can stun or kill, while piranha are known to bite and injure humans. Various species of poison dart frogs secrete lipophilic alkaloid toxins through their flesh. There are also numerous parasites and disease vectors. Vampire bats dwell in the rainforest and can spread the rabies virus. Malaria, yellow fever and dengue fever can also be contracted in the Amazon region.

However, the Amazon Rainforest is facing severe threats from deforestation, primarily driven by agricultural expansion, logging, and mining. Since the 1980s, an area roughly the size of France has been cleared, leading to loss of biodiversity, increased greenhouse gas emissions, and disrupted indigenous communities.

Efforts to protect the Amazon include the establishment of protected areas, sustainable forest management, and international cooperation to combat deforestation. Organizations and governments are working to balance economic development with environmental conservation.

- i) Amazon rainforest covers an area of
 - a) Approximately 5.05 million square kilometers
 - b) Approximately 5.55 million square meters
 - c) Approximately 5.5 million square kilometers
 - d) Approximately 5.55 million square kilometers
- ii) Amazon rainforest
 - a) Produces about 25% of the world's oxygen and flowing 15% of the fresh water
 - b) Home for 10% of all known plants and animal species and produces 20% of

the world's oxygen

- c) Plants and trees vary by about 15% as a result of seasonal changes
- d) Accounting for about 20% of the fresh water flowing into the oceans 1
- iii) Why is amazon rainforest referred to as the 'lungs of the earth'? 2
- iv) Severe threats faced by amazon rainforests _____ 2
- v) Match the following: 1

A) Eel	I) Rabies virus
B) Frogs	II) Bites and injures humans
C) Vampire bats	III) Electric shock to kill
D) Piranha	IV) Secrete lipophilic alkaloid toxins

- a) A-I, B-II, C-III, D-IV
- b) A-II, B-III, C-IV, D-I
- c) A-III, B-IV, C-II, D-I
- d) A-III, B-IV, C-I, D-II
- vi) What measurements are taken to protect the amazon rainforests? 2
- vii) Find a word from the passage opposite to the meaning of 'uninterrupted'. 1

SECTION B-WRITING AND GRAMMAR (20 marks)

GRAMMAR

10 Marks

3. Complete ANY TEN of the following questions.

- a) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the verb in the brackets:
He eventually faced the harsh truth of her mortality, _____ (realize) that now she has become a part of nature. 1
- b) Identify the error and supply the correction for the following:
Sparkle Clean services is ready to clean your home or office. We have trained staff who is equipped with the best tools. For a free quote, call us at 555-CLEAN.
Use the given format for your response. 1
- | Error | correction |
|-------|------------|
| | |
- c) A student wanted to issue a book. He asked the librarian to allow him. Report the student's question.
Will you allow me to issue this book today? I will return it tomorrow. 1
- d) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket:

When the storm finally ceased, we discovered that the old tree by the riverbank _____ (fall) blocking the path. 1

e) Select the correct option to fill in the blank for the given

Many a great scholar _____ struggled with this very problem.

i) Have

ii) Has

iii) Is

iv) Are 1

f) Choose the correct one to complete the sentence

Some of the programmes _____ (that/ those/ these) are telecast these days are of a very poor quality. 1

g) Gina was asked to convert sentence A to reported speech. What will be her answer?

Sentence A: Larissa said, "Why don't you join me for dinner tonight?" 1

h) Find out the error in the given sentence.

He is one of those people who thinks money is everything. 1

i) Fill in the blank with the correct option from those given in the brackets.

The court warned the representative that he _____ (should not/ would not) tamper with the evidence. 1

j) By the time we reach, the school bell _____.

i) Will be ringing

ii) Will have rung

iii) Would have been ringing

iv) Would have rung 1

k) Choose the correct option to fill in the blank.

_____ information provided was helpful.

i) Little

ii) A little

iii) The little

iv) Few 1

l) Fill in the blank to complete the sentence. 1

The plumber along with his helper _____ expected to come soon. (is/ are)

WRITING

10 Marks

4. Attempt ANY ONE of the following in 100-120 words.

You are Sanjana/Sanjay of 12B, Model Town, Delhi. You recently came across an advertisement for a short-term course in web design offered by the "Institute of Digital Arts." After your final board examinations, you wish to enrol in this course to develop new skills.

Write a letter to the Director of the Institute of Digital Arts, inquiring about the course details. Your letter should include questions about the course duration, eligibility criteria, fees, class timings, and any potential job placement assistance. 5

OR

You are the Secretary of your residential welfare association. Write a letter to the editor of a local daily, expressing your concern over the noise pollution caused by loudspeakers

during festivals and celebrations. Mention the ill effects and suggest measures to curb this menace. You are Raman/Ramya of RWA Apartments, Civil Lines, Delhi. 5

5. Attempt ANY ONE of the following in 100-120 words.

Write an analytical paragraph on the growing menace of junk food. Use the following cues and your own ideas to develop your argument.

Cues:

Convenience: Easy availability and quick preparation.

Health Hazards: Links to obesity, diabetes, and heart problems.

Marketing Strategy: Attractive packaging and advertising targeted at children.

Dietary Habits: Replacing nutritious home-cooked meals.

Long-Term Impact: Effects on overall public health.

5

OR

Write an analytical paragraph on the importance of environmental conservation in today's world. Use the following cues and your own ideas to explore the topic.

Cues:

Biodiversity: Protecting various species of plants and animals.

Natural Resources: Conserving water, air, and land for future generations.

Climate Change: Mitigating the effects of global warming.

Human Health: Impact of pollution on well-being.

Sustainable Development: Balancing economic growth with environmental protection. 5

SECTION D - LITERATURE (40 MARKS)

6. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two: 5 Marks

A) 'Paper has more patience than people.' I thought of this saying on one of those days when I was feeling a little depressed and was sitting at home with my chin in my hands, bored and listless, wondering whether to stay in or go out. I finally stayed where I was, brooding: Yes, paper does have more patience, and since I'm not planning to let anyone else read this stiff-backed notebook grandly referred to as a 'diary', unless I should ever find a real friend, it probably won't make a bit of difference.

(From The Diary of Anne Frank)

a. What is the narrator's attitude toward the diary?

1

- b. What does the narrator's decision to "stay where I was, brooding" tell you about her state of mind? 1
- c. The narrator mentions not planning to share the diary with anyone "unless I should ever find a real friend." What does this imply about her view of a "real friend"? 2
- d. Which phrase from the opening paragraph best illustrates the narrator's deep-seated loneliness, which precedes her decision to write in the diary?
 - i. "bored and listless"
 - ii. "sitting at home with my chin in my hands"
 - iii. "unless I should ever find a real friend"
 - iv. "grandly referred to as a 'diary'" 1

OR

B) I awoke late next morning to find that Anil had already made the tea. He stretched out his hand towards me. There was a fifty-rupee note between his fingers. My heart sank. I thought I had been discovered. "I made some money yesterday," he explained. "Now you'll be paid regularly." My spirits rose. But when I took the note, I saw it was still wet from the night's rain. "Today we'll start writing sentences," he said. He knew. But neither his lips nor his eyes showed anything. I smiled at Anil in my most appealing way. And the smile came by itself, without any effort. (The Thief's Story)

- i. When the narrator saw the fifty-rupee note, his heart "sank." This indicates he felt:
 - a) gratitude for the payment
 - b) regret over his decision to steal.
 - c) panic about being caught.
 - d) surprised by Anil's generosity. 1
- ii. Use textual evidence to explain how Hari's emotions shifted from initial panic to relief and genuine happiness. 1
- iii. What does the wet note represent in this context? 1
- iv. The narrator's smile "came by itself, without any effort" after Anil's actions. Contrast the appealing smile at the beginning with that of the end? 2

7. Read the given extracts A and B and answer ANY ONE of the two: 5 Marks

A) A dime, another ball, is worthless. Now

He senses first responsibility

In a world of possessions. People will take

Balls, balls will be lost always, little boy.

And no one buys a ball back. Money is external.

(The Ball Poem)

- i. "He senses first responsibility" refers to the boy's realization that he must...
 - a) Be more careful with his belongings.
 - b) Learn to take care of his feelings.
 - c) Be responsible for all that happens.
 - d) Learn to cope with an irreplaceable loss. 1
- ii. What is the "world of possessions" mentioned in the poem? 1
- iii. "In a world of possessions"- is an example of which poetic device? 1
- iv. What does "Money is external" signify? 2

OR

B) The leaves strain toward the glass

small twigs stiff with exertion

long-cramped boughs shuffling under the roof

like newly discharged patients

half-dazed, moving

to the clinic doors.

(The Trees)

- i. What does the comparison to "newly discharged patients, half-dazed, moving" suggest about the boughs? 1
- ii. Which word best describes the atmosphere created by the imagery of the leaves and twigs straining and stiff with exertion?
 - a) Tranquillity
 - b) Celebration
 - c) Urgency
 - d) Indifference 1
- iii. How does the use of personification throughout the excerpt affect the overall mood? 2
- iv. What does the "glass" represent in this context? 1

8. Answer ANY FOUR of the following five questions in about 50 words each. 4x3=12

- I. Discuss what unique challenges and rewards might a person face when bonding with a semi-aquatic wild animal like an otter?
- II. The phrase "languid, emerald sea" uses vivid imagery. What specific feeling or state of being does this imagery help Amanda achieve in her imagination?

- III. Was the pilot's choice to "take the risk" a demonstration of bravery or irresponsibility? Justify your answer using evidence from the story and the provided extract. (The Black Aeroplane)
- IV. Analyse the mood created by the poem's (Fog) structure and language. How do the short, free verse lines contribute to the quiet, subtle atmosphere of the fog's arrival and departure?
- V. How does the escalated argument in The Proposal exemplify the playwright's critique of the trivial reasons that often lead to major conflicts in human relationships?

9. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions in about 40-50 words. 2x3=6

- I. Discuss how might the entire tragedy of the story have been avoided if Matilda had adopted a more content or pragmatic mindset, similar to her husband's?
- II. The woman mentions, "You won't get caught." How does this line become ironically true for Horace, but not in the way he initially assumes?
- III. Evaluate the effectiveness of the "footprints" as a literary device. How do they create mystery and suspense while also providing the only physical evidence of the invisible man's presence?

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. 1x6=6

- A. "He who has drawn out the arrow and has become composed will obtain peace of mind." Interpret the symbolic meaning of "drawing out the arrow" in this quote. In the context of modern life and stress management, suggest practical ways one can "draw out the arrow of lamentation, complaint, and grief" to obtain peace. (Sermon at Benares)

OR

- B. How does the interaction between Valli and the conductor highlight the theme of appearance vs. reality? (The reality of her age vs. the appearance of her maturity and independence).

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. 1x6=6

- A. Evaluate Max's failure to question the existence of the balcony more thoroughly. What character flaws (perhaps overconfidence in his own authority with a gun, or succumbing to panic) led him to believe Ausable's story so easily?

OR

- B. Evaluate Bholi's parents' decision-making process. Was their relief at Bishamber's initial offer (considering his flaws) a sign of desperation or a reflection of societal pressures regarding marriage and the treatment of girls?

